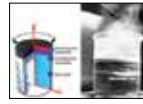




Importance of Oceans

Read to find out how the oceans play an important role in supporting life on exoplanets <http://dgit.in/ImpOceans>



Sponge to produce steam

Researchers at MIT have built a sponge-like structure that can produce steam from water using sunlight <http://dgit.in/SpongeSteam>

TRAILBLAZERS, NOT PART OF OUR TOP TEN BUT WHO LEFT AN INDELIBLE MARK ON THE COMPUTING LANDSCAPE



Ralph H. Baer (Video Game Console)

Considered to be the "father of video games", Ralph built the first commercial home video game console named 'Magnavox Odyssey' after working on a prototype called 'Brown Box', forging the video game industry in 1972. He also created the first light gun, a peripheral device for consoles that you might have worn out with use in the popular *Duck Hunt* to shoot down ducks on the Nintendo Entertainment System (NES) video game console.



William Fetter (Computer Graphics)

While working as a graphic designer at Boeing, Fetter created the first computer model of a human body known as 'Boeing Man' referred to by Fetter as 'First Man'. It was used as a standard figure of a pilot in Boeing to test whether the pilot was able to reach all the

instruments in a virtual cockpit set-up. To describe the work he was doing at Boeing, he coined the term 'Computer Graphics'.



Gary Thuerk (Spamming)

After a new model of a computer was available at Digital Equipment Corporation, Gary Thuerk, a marketing representative at the company, came

up with the ingenious advertising idea of sending out a mass email to 393 recipients with the help of an assistant on the ARPAnet. Since then, Internet pipes have been spewing spam all the time, being not just a nuisance for your inbox to deal with on a daily basis, but also negatively impacting companies that run the Internet.

David Bradley (Ctrl+Alt+Del)

David designed the three-finger salute, or the 'Control+Alt+Delete' command, initially intended to perform a reboot function without shutting down the computer, a useful feature to developers and



programmers. It was originally made for IBM PC-compatible computers, and now the Control+Alt+Delete shortcut invokes the task manager in Windows XP and later. Linux performs

a soft reboot too, while reboot on the Mac OS works with a different command.



Gary Kildall (BIOS)

He created the mass-market CP/M operating system and went on to create the concept of BIOS, which is the first software that runs on

your PC when it's turned on. The BIOS basically tests whether the hardware components of your computer are running properly and then loads the operating system to the memory device. Gary is also known as the man who missed out on a crucial meeting with IBM, which let Bill Gates cut a deal with DOS, later turning Gates into the richest man on earth.

from manually performing the task every time. The Father of AI also came up with the concept of computer time-sharing and networking, which was a precursor to cloud computing. In the 1970s, John presented a paper which spoke about buying and selling via computers, clearly predicting the e-commerce system.

8 Charles Bachman (Database Management System)



When direct-access storage (disks and drums) became available, there arose the need for a system to handle all the data. Working at General Electric as an engineer, a dyslexic

Bachman developed the Integrated Data Store (IDS), which was the first proper working database management system (DBMS). Also, called "navigational database", this system went on to become the world's most useful technology. One can't

even imagine how today's flight reservation systems and inventory control systems would have been possible without a DBMS.

9 Leslie Lamport (Distributed Computing)



The benefits of a computer network

in an organisation are obvious, however the reliability of the data exchanged hasn't always been guaranteed. Enter the concept of "distributed computing" chalked out by Leslie

while working at Stanford Research Institute. He invented various algorithms for software that would ensure the reliability of functioning even when there are separate machines with multiple cores and multiple processors running. Today's cloud and web services are powered by the same concept. Without distributed computing, massively multiplayer online games such as *World of Warcraft* and *Age of Empires*, as well as P2P applications would probably not exist.

10 Douglas T. Ross (CAD)



Ross is credited with

leading the development of APT (Automatically Programmable Tool) – a high-level programming language used to write instructions for numerically controlled

machine tools in creating complex parts with cutting tools such as mills, lathes, plasma cutters and water jet cutters, moving in space. Computers are now used for such precision-based tasks, automated by computer-aided design (CAD) and computer-aided manufacturing (CAM) programs. These software are used to create 2D and 3D models of parts in the automotive, shipbuilding and aerospace industries, among many others. Ross also originated the term "CAD" and made significant contribution to the future development of CAD. 